

A Quiet Promise

I am not the silk drape, threaded with gold,
nor the conch's low cry stirring the dawn.
I am the brass lamp, small and unassuming,
my body dulled by years of flame and smoke.
My edges are worn smooth by devoted hands
that lifted me daily, without question.

They placed me on the checkered wooden floor,
beside a plate of food and a quiet hope.
My wick, thin as a whisper,
drank the oil of memory
and burned steady through dusk and doubt.

In the corner of the prayer room
I watched the grandmother's fingers tremble,
and later, her daughter's, gracefully sure.
I saw her shadows bow, and mine rise
many souls, one flame.

When the winds howled and the lights failed,
I was still there, a golden eye in the dark,
a quiet promise: you are not alone.

Tonight, a new generation's hands
reach for me, small and curious.
The match-strike sounds a familiar song,
and my wick awakens once more.

I am part of their ritual, their reverence;
not because I am needed, but because I am here.
I watch them grow, year by year,
as the family pauses to find its center.
And in their light, I burn on.